

October

21

1879

Light bulb

US inventor Thomas Edison made an application to patent his design for a light bulb, which had a burning carbon filament inside. Practical and affordable, his invention could light a space for more than 13 hours.

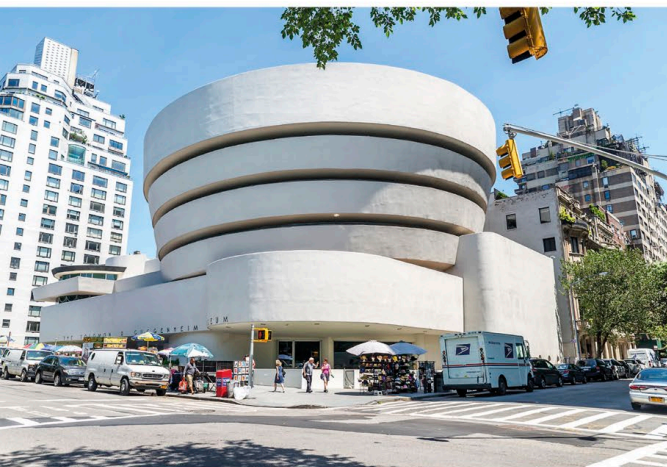


Born this day

1833 Alfred Nobel, Swedish chemist. He donated his wealth to create the Nobel Prize, which is awarded to leading figures who have contributed to the benefit of humankind.

New art gallery 1959

In New York City, USA, the Solomon R Guggenheim Museum opened to visitors. The building's unusual modern design was unlike any art gallery seen before.



Tokugawa victory 1600

In the Battle of Sekigahara, the forces of Tokugawa Ieyasu defeated the ruling Toyotomi clan. This victory led to the establishment of the Tokugawa Shogunate, a military government that ruled Japan for the next two and a half centuries.

1854 Champion nurse

British nursing pioneer Florence Nightingale left England for Constantinople (modern-day Istanbul, Turkey), where she introduced new standards of cleanliness in disease-ridden hospitals filled with soldiers wounded in the Crimean War.



Also on this day

1520 Portuguese explorer Ferdinand Magellan's ships began to navigate a narrow waterway in southern Chile that linked the Atlantic and Pacific oceans.

1805 British ships defeated the French and Spanish fleets at the Battle of Trafalgar, off the Spanish coast.